

Pakistan Legislature Structure

Introduction

Pakistan's federal legislature is the Parliament. It has two houses: the Senate (upper house) and the National Assembly (lower house). The President is part of Parliament and can summon or end sessions.

Composition and Term

National Assembly

- It has 336 members:
 - 266 general seats, chosen by direct vote.
 - 60 reserved seats for women.
 - 10 reserved seats for non-Muslims.
- Members serve five-year terms, unless the Assembly is dissolved earlier.

Senate

- It has 96 seats.
- Each province has 23 senators.
- Islamabad has 4 senators.
- Members serve six-year terms.
- Elections happen every three years for half of the seats.

Leadership and Key Figures

National Assembly

- The Speaker leads sessions and acts impartially.
- The Deputy Speaker takes over when the Speaker is absent.

Senate

- The Chairman presides over the Senate.
- If the President is absent, the Chairman acts as President.

Law-Making Process

- Both houses must pass a bill, and the President must approve it for it to become law.
- a Mediation Committee is formed if the disagreement appears between two houses.

Cabinet and Accountability

- The Prime Minister is selected from the National Assembly.
- Ministers must be members of Parliament.
- No more than one-quarter of them can be from the Senate.

Conclusion

Pakistan's federal legislature is bicameral. Each house has distinct roles. The system balances representation by population in the National Assembly and equal provincial representation in the Senate. Both houses work together to pass laws.

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